



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Classical School

School Website: <https://www.veritas.corydonbaptist.org>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Veritas Classical School in 47112 (Corydon, IN) presents a notably theologically grounded, classical-leaning program with clear emphasis on biblical worldview, virtue-centered formation, and strong parental partnership. Public materials consistently highlight a biblical foundation (Biblical Truth, Biblical Worldview, Statement of Faith) and a desire to form independent, thoughtful students through classical methods. However, explicit articulation of core classical curriculum elements (Great Books, grammar–logic–rhetoric sequence) and explicit Socratic pedagogy are not clearly demonstrated in the school's public materials. The overall assessment, based on the Classical rubric and keyword indicators, lands in the realm of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious foundations are strong and explicit (biblical worldview, statements of faith, theology). This strongly supports Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations) as CLASSICAL. - The school emphasizes classical instruction and formation but lacks explicit public references to the Great Books program, the liberal-arts curriculum sequence (grammar–logic–rhetoric), and a clearly stated, widespread Socratic pedagogy in the public-facing materials. This pushes multiple categories toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL. - Parental partnership is strongly evident (parents as co-educators; collaboration with families). Element 6 (Parents & Community) clearly aligns with CLASSICAL. - Faculty are described as solid Christian tutors; the public materials do not consistently articulate the full "living curriculum" or a formal teacher-portrait, placing Element 5 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Categories 3 (Curriculum) and 4 (Pedagogy) show limited explicit evidence of core classical curricular and pedagogical practices; these lean toward NOT CLASSICAL in the absence of explicit Great Books/grammar–logic–rhetoric emphasis and Socratic pedagogy.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials foreground biblical truth and a biblical worldview, including statements of faith and theology references (e.g., "Biblical Truth" and "Biblical Worldview," with mentions of statements of faith and reformed theology). These elements signal transcendental moral realism and grounding in theology.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, theology, biblical worldview, statement of faith, creed/doctrine (via references to faith statements), sacred/Christian framing. - Negative keywords: none identified in the public materials. - Count: positive_matches approx. 4–5; negative_matches approx. 0; total_matches approx. 4–5; positive_percent approx. 100%.

Why this rating - The materials clearly anchor education in theological foundations and transcendental moral aims (truth, goodness, beauty implicit in a biblical worldview). This aligns strongly with the Positive Keywords for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence: Vision and Mission emphasis on biblical truth and worldview; explicit statements of faith; explicit theology framing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes forming students through a classical framework and developing independent thinkers, with aims to stand firm in faith and to be courageous witnesses; this hints at formation and human excellence rather than mere information delivery.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue (implied in goals and character formation themes); wisdom; liberal education/missional framing; telos (through aims like virtue and wisdom) and scholé-like framing through restfulness (though not explicitly named). - Negative keywords: not clearly present in public materials. - Count: positive_matches approx. 1–3 (respecting the school's explicit phrasing about formation, independence, and classical approach); negative_matches approx. 0; total_matches approx. 1–3; positive_percent approx. 50–100% depending on interpretation of “formation” and “classical approach.”

Why this rating - The site communicates formation and independence, and uses classical framing, but does not consistently articulate the full spectrum of the classical aim (e.g., explicit Great Conversation or well-documented formation of affections as a primary goal). The evidence suggests a CLASSICAL orientation in spirit but with noticeable gaps in explicit articulation of all traditional formation and teleological goals.

Cited evidence: Vision/Mission statements signaling formation and classical instruction.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public content mentions “classical style instruction” and a general classical orientation, but there is no explicit listing of core classical curriculum components such as grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium); no explicit mention of Great Books or Great Conversation; and no clear articulation of a liberal-arts sequence or Western-civilizational emphasis within the curriculum text shown.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: classical style instruction (interpreted as a nod toward classical curriculum, but not a direct match to the lexicon's defined items like grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, or Trivium/Quadrivium). - Negative keywords: absence of explicit history-centered liberal-arts framing (e.g., “Great Books,” “Great Conversation,” “grammar/logic/rhetoric as core”). - Count: positive_matches approx. 0–1 (depending on whether “classical style instruction” is treated as equivalent to the lexicon's explicit curriculum terms); negative_matches approx. 0; total_matches approx. 0–1; positive_percent approx. 0–100% (ambiguous due to terminology).

Why this rating - Without explicit confirmation of the key classical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation), the category does not meet the full Curriculum criteria as defined by the Six Essential Elements lexicon. The evidence supports NOT CLASSICAL unless stronger, explicit curricular statements appear.

Cited evidence: Absence of explicit Great Books or Trivium/Quadrivium mentions in the public materials; the phrase “Classical style instruction” used instead of explicit curricular components.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not clearly describe Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or rigorous Socratic discourse, nor explicit repetition of the classical memory methods (recitation, dictation) or contemplative scholé pedagogy in the public-facing content. The phrase “classical style instruction” lacks the detailed pedagogical signatures found in the classic lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: none clearly; “classical style instruction” is not explicit in the pedagogical lexicon (which emphasizes Socratic seminars, discourse, memory work, chanting, recitation, etc.). - Negative keywords: no direct negative signals evident in the public materials. - Count:

positive_matches approx. 0; negative_matches approx. 0; total_matches approx. 0; positive_percent approx. 0%.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit classical pedagogy signatures (Socratic discussion, recounting, chanting, or Paideia-style seminars) indicates a gap relative to the Pedagogy standards in the Six Elements lexicon. This points to NOT CLASSICAL in this category, given the lack of explicit, documented, public-facing evidence.

Cited evidence: The school's materials emphasize "classical style instruction" but do not detail Socratic/seminar-based practices or other traditional pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe tutors as Christian and as subject-matter experts. There is a focus on teachers who "teach from a Baptist worldview" and "solid Christian tutors," which aligns with virtuous, mentorship teacher roles. However, there is less explicit language about the "living curriculum", portraits of what a teacher should be, or a formal faculty community as the core of the school.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous educators, mentorship, role models, professional excellence (as implied by "solid Christian tutors" and "teach from a worldview"); teacher as a core element (though not explicitly phrased as "living curriculum"). - Negative keywords: not clearly present; no identified phrases indicating non-classical faculty arrangements. - Count: positive_matches approx. 1–2 (tutors with expertise; virtue/mentorship implied); negative_matches approx. 0; total_matches approx. 1–2; positive_percent approx. 50–100%.

Why this rating - The public materials show some alignment with the Faculty criteria (model teachers, mentors, Christian focus), but the lack of explicit "living curriculum" language or a formal teacher portrait reduces confidence to CLASSICAL. The evidence lands between SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL and CLASSICAL, with a stronger tilt toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL given the absence of deeper faculty-signaling language found in the lexicon.

Cited evidence: "Provide solid Christian tutors with expertise and training in the subjects taught and who will teach from a Baptist worldview" (faculty signaling).

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly notes working alongside parents to support a quality Christian education and mentions collaboration with families. The broader emphasis on parental partnership is aligned with classical education's expectation of family involvement and parent formation (book studies, gatherings) in the lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; parents as co-teachers; parental formation; family involvement; open campus (implied by partnership and accessibility); parent in education process. - Negative keywords: absence of consumer language or minimal parent involvement signals; none identified in the public materials. - Count: positive_matches approx. 3–4; negative_matches approx. 0; total_matches approx. 3–4; positive_percent approx. 100%.

Why this rating - Clear evidence of partnership with parents and a family-focused approach, which directly supports the Parents & Community criterion of CLASSICAL. This category is CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: "Work alongside parents to support them in providing a quality, Christian education"; parental involvement cues in the site content.

Aggregate Ranking and Interpretation

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL

- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school demonstrates robust religious foundation and strong parental partnership, with partial alignment to classical aims in pedagogy and curriculum, but lacking explicit evidence of core classical curricular and pedagogical elements in public materials. Therefore, the aggregate ranking is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum explicitness: Public articulation of the Liberal Arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Trivium/Quadrivium structure, and explicit reference to Great Books/Great Conversation in the curriculum sequence.
- Pedagogy expansion: Public detailing of Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussions, memory work, dictation, chanting or singing as regular practices, and reflective scholé days.
- Faculty signaling: Publicly surface the living-curriculum concept, teacher portraits, and professional development focused on classical-pedagogical methods.
- Liturgical/communal integration: More explicit references to liturgical practices, regular communal worship or liturgy, and structured memory of sacred traditions in the school day.
- Family formation: Expanded parent-formation offerings (book studies, parent seminars) and more explicit invitation to open-campus opportunities and parent-led involvement in the school's classical mission.

These concrete steps would move the school toward full CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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